

Succeeding in Your Job Search

Running your search with method and confidence

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

CONTENTS

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1. Before you begin
2. The 4 approaches
3. Psychodynamic lens
4. CBT lens
5. Humanistic lens
6. Systemic lens
7. Tips & advice
8. Your workbook
9. Your 4-week plan

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Running your search with method and confidence

Looking for a job can be draining: applications with no reply, doubts, discouragement. Yet an effective search isn't just luck — it's a method, and a mindset you maintain.

This guide helps you keep your morale, clarify what you're truly looking for, and run a tooled, targeted search.

Your intention

Where you are (or stuck) in your search: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

What the search stirs up

Each rejection can wake a fear of rejection and doubt about your worth. If the search affects you so much, it's rubbing against old wounds — not because you're 'worth less'.

Understanding it helps you not take each 'no' as a verdict on you.

Example

After ten rejections, Sami thought himself 'useless'. Linking the discouragement to an old fear of rejection helped him bounce back.

What rejections stir up

What do you feel at each rejection? What does it take you back to?

Proof from the facts

List 3 past work wins that prove your worth, independent of this search.

→ *A rejection isn't a verdict on my worth.*

The thoughts that discourage

'No one wants me', 'all these rejections = I'm useless': generalization turns a few 'no's into a global condemnation.

Softening these thoughts keeps you in action.

Example

Nia saw each rejection as 'proof' of incompetence. Reframing (normal response rates) restored her momentum.

Search journal

Note: the discouraging thought · a fairer version · my next action.

Rejection as a statistic

How many applications per interview on average? See a rejection as a number, not a judgment.

→ *A rejection is a statistic, not a condemnation.*

Clarifying what you truly seek

Looking for 'a job' tires you; looking for THE role that fits you motivates you. Clarifying your strengths, values and non-negotiables makes your search fairer and more convincing.

You're looking for a place where your worth will be useful, not just a paycheck.

Example

By defining what truly mattered to her, Léa targeted fewer roles — but far more relevant ones.

My strengths & values

Write: my 3 strengths · my work values · my 3 non-negotiables.

The role that fits me

Describe in 3 lines the role where you'd be in your place.

→ *I seek where my worth will be useful — not just anything.*

A tooled search

An effective search: a CV and LinkedIn targeted per role, activating your network (the 'hidden market' holds many roles), targeted rather than mass applications, and regular follow-up.

Method turns scattering into results.

Example

By activating her network rather than 'spraying', Sofia landed two interviews through contacts in a week.

My search plan

Note: my target · my channels (network, postings, spontaneous) · my weekly routine.

Activate my network

List 5 people to reconnect with this week + the message you'll send.

→ *Targeting and activating my network beats spraying.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Target rather than spray: fewer applications, better prepared.
- Tailor CV and LinkedIn to each role (the posting's keywords).
- Activate your network: the hidden market = most roles.
- Prepare your STAR examples (Situation · Task · Action · Result).
- Treat a rejection as a stat, not a verdict; ask for feedback.
- Set a routine (X applications/week) and tend to your morale.

To fill in

Search journal

Date	Application / contact	Status	Next action

My network

Person to reconnect with	My message

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Defuse what rejections stir up.

Week 2 — Reframe the thoughts that discourage.

Week 3 — Clarify my target (strengths, values).

Week 4 — Activate network & search routine.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The role I target:
- The 3 network people to activate:
- My weekly routine:

TO CLOSE

With method and mindset, your search moves forward.

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This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy. If you are going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.